

When Defeat Is Blamed on Treason Instead of the Enemy's Military System

Comparative cases for the collapse of English Normandy, 1449–1453

Research report — every factual claim below is sourced to a page fetched in this session and linked to the exact URL. Unverified fields are marked `n.a.`

0. The baseline case (Normandy 1449–53), stated for calibration

The French "stack." From 1444 Charles VII "reorganized France," including financially, "with the creation of a permanent tax," and created the *compagnies d'ordonnance*, "the first form of a standing army in French history," so that by 1449 he could field "15,000 to 20,000 well-trained and well-paid men" ([Wikipedia, Normandy campaign of 1449–1450](#)). The fiscal step is explicit: the king "gradually managed to convince the États généraux to make the land tax permanent," and "with this new source of funding" promulgated the Grande Ordonnance de Louppy-le-Château of 26 May 1445, establishing "a permanent army made of 15 companies at the exclusive service of the King" — "a permanent army of 9,000 men who were paid in both times of war and peace" — plus garrison *mortes-payes* and, in 1448, the tax-exempt *franc-archers* as "the reserve of the permanent army" ([Musée de l'Armée](#)). Artillery was the second layer: after 1420 "crumbed" gunpowder spread and did not separate in transport; breech chambers gave a "remarkably rapid (if brief) rate of fire"; and Jean and Gaspard Bureau "are generally credited with making Charles VII's artillery such a formidable force," notably by regularizing its "seemingly chaotic variety" ([Osprey, The Fall of English France 1449–53, sample text](#)). At Castillon on 17 July 1453 "the French camp was defended by a ditch in which the artillery was positioned, hidden from the sight of the English" ([Musée de l'Armée](#)). Operationally the effect was tempo, not spectacle: two converging armies (French from the east, Breton from the west), Pont-Audemer on 12 August 1449, Lisieux on 16 August, then Dieppe, Fécamp, Arques, Pont-de-l'Arche, Conches, Verneuil, Gerberoy, Coutances, Saint-Lô, Carentan (evacuated the day before the Bretons arrived), Valognes — then Formigny on 15 April 1450, where Richemont "deployed methodically behind the English" and Kyriell's army was "annihilated" ([Wikipedia, Normandy campaign](#)).

The English attribution. English contemporaries read this as domestic betrayal. The Kentish rebels' *Proclamation of Grievances* (4 June 1450) states: "his false council has lost his law, his merchandise is lost, his common people is destroyed, the sea is lost, France is lost, the king himself is so set that he may not pay for his meat nor drink, and he owes more than ever any King of England ought, for daily his traitors about him..." and demands removal of "all the false progeny and affinity of the Duke of Suffolk... the false traitor, the Duke of Suffolk" ([Fordham Medieval Sourcebook](#)). Suffolk's 1444 marriage negotiation contained "a secret clause [that] returned Maine and Anjou to France," which "was to contribute to his downfall"; he was "accused of maladministration by many," suspected of "being a traitor," arrested 28 January 1450, banished, intercepted at sea and beheaded ([Wikipedia, William de la Pole](#)). The fiscal reality

behind "unpaid garrisons" is documented: English "direct taxation had been bringing in ever-less cash since the mid-14th century; it had slumped since 1430 and had reached a particularly low level in the 1450s," while Parliament had planned "to use the conquered territories in northern France as a source of revenue, but as these slipped from English control so their revenues declined" — and Adam Moleyns was "killed by mutinous troops in Southampton" in 1450 ([Osprey sample](#)).

The comparative question is therefore: where else did a defeated elite/public attribute a systemic, institutionally driven collapse to treason, betrayal or moral failure?

A. Ranked shortlist: the eight strongest analogues

#	Case / date	Actual innovation or integrated "stack"	What the defeated side said instead (direct quotation, dated)	Mechanism of the attribution	Analogy strength to Normandy
1	Germany, 1918 (Hundred Days → armistice)	Foch's multi-army sequential offensives; at Amiens, 8 Aug 1918, "nearly 20 divisions, three cavalry divisions, 244 Mark V tanks, 120 supply tanks, 96 Whippet light tanks, more than 3,000 heavy artillery pieces, and more than 800 Royal Air Force aircraft," with "a coordinated, rolling artillery barrage with advancing infantry" rather than a preliminary bombardment, plus counter-battery fire that "cut enemy communications and silenced enemy guns" (Saber & Scroll, <i>The Battle of Amiens</i>); Allied freedom of movement, "a steady stream of American troops, and resupply" versus Germans with "little to no reserves left" (same). By 5 Oct 1918 the Allies had broken "the entire depth" of the Hindenburg Line on a 19-mile front (Wikipedia, <i>Hundred Days Offensive</i>)	Hindenburg, sworn testimony to the Reichstag inquiry, 18 Nov 1919: "At this time, the secret intentional mutilation of the fleet and the army began as a continuation of similar occurrences in peace time... Thus did our operations necessarily miscarry; the collapse was inevitable; the revolution only provided the keystone... An English general said with justice: 'The German army was stabbed in the back.'... No guilt applies to the good core of the army" (German History in Documents and Images)	Deliberate self-exculpation, pre-planned. Ludendorff had privately told staff on 1 Oct 1918 that "the O.H.L. and the German army were at an end; the war could no longer be won; indeed, a total defeat could probably no longer be averted," while simultaneously asking the Kaiser "to include in the government those circles who are largely responsible... Let them be the ones to sign the peace treaty... Let them clean up the mess they got us into" (GHDI, Thaeer diary). Military leaders "had kept the truth about the collapsing military situation from the population" and "helped spread this false idea" (USHMM)	High. Same structure as 1450: an unwinnable attritional-institutional position (manpower, allies, logistics) is recoded as internal betrayal; the accusers are the responsible elite; the narrative then drives domestic political violence

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2	France, 1870 (Sedan, Metz)	Prussian operational tempo and staff work: French movement "5 miles a day, compared with the enemy's 15 miles a day"; "the German staff calculated that Bazaine was nearing Verdun" while the French had "barely got their artillery and baggage trains through the town of Metz"; a single cavalry patrol's report on 15 Aug 1870 at 1900 produced an immediate order sending 30,000 men of III Corps to cut the retreat at Mars-la-Tour/Vionville, where Alvensleben "held off four French corps for seven hours"; plus "the Prussian all-steel Krupp breech-loading gun" (Wikipedia, Bazaine)	Gambetta, proclamation, 30 Oct 1870: "Metz a capitulé... Le maréchal Bazaine a trahi !... L'armée de la France... est engloutie, malgré l'héroïsme des soldats, par la trahison des chefs" (Daloz, text of the Tours proclamation); and, to the soldiers, "Vous avez été trahis, mais non déshonorés... vous savez aujourd'hui à quels désastres l'ineptie et la trahison peuvent conduire les plus vaillantes armées" (Proclamation, 1 Nov 1870)	Political scapegoating, institutionalised in a court. Bazaine was tried from 6 Oct 1873 and condemned to death, later commuted (Wikipedia). His counsel named the mechanism on 7 Dec 1873: "Les nations viriles n'ont pas d'injustes soupçons pour les hommes qui, chargés de les défendre, ont succombé sous le nombre... Les peuples faibles, au contraire, cherchent une victime; ils l'immolent, et il leur semble que leur douleur est moins amère" (Le Droit Criminel, procès Bazaine)	High. Closest institutional twin: a capitulation of fortress + field army under a superior <i>system</i> is prosecuted as personal treason; the accusation is issued <i>while the war is still running</i>, exactly as with Suffolk/Somerset in 1450

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3	Egypt/Jordan/Syria, June 1967	Israeli intelligence-airpower-command stack (see \$D for the limits of this session's evidence on the Israeli side). Its indirect signature was what the losers found inexplicable: simultaneous strikes on "all military and civilian airports," from an unexpected axis (American Rhetoric transcript, 9 June 1967)	Nasser, resignation broadcast, 9 June 1967 : "the enemy, whom we anticipated to strike from the east and north, attacked from the west, confirming that he was given facilities that go beyond his capabilities... there is clear evidence of colonial collusion with him... it is now confirmed that American and British aircraft carriers were near the enemy's shores, assisting his war effort" (American Rhetoric). Radio Amman, 6 June 1967: "there are three aircraft carriers close inshore from which aircraft take off to bomb our forces"; Radio Damascus claimed "seventeen British Vulcan bombers... had arrived in Israel ten days before the outbreak of the war" (Middle East Quarterly, "The Lie That Won't Die")	Knowing fabrication used as regime maintenance. It served as "an excuse for the ignominious defeat," reframed as "Egypt was fighting the great imperialist powers, and not only the miserable Jews," "gave Nasser a lever... in begging for Soviet aid," and "deflected anger from Egyptian leadership"; "the Soviet Union hastened to inform the Egyptians that their intelligence did not show any indications of US participation in the war" (zionism-israel.com documents page). The claim survived in textbooks: "Israel launched the war with the support of Britain and the United States" (same)	High. The purest modern instance of a capability gap being narrated as betrayal/collusion because the losing side's model of the balance made the observed tempo arithmetically impossible

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4	USSR, summer–autumn 1941	German army-group system: AGC with ~50 divisions incl. 9 Panzer and 5 motorized; Panzer pincers producing single/double encirclements with "infantry [as] the inner ring and armor the outer ring"; <i>Schwerpunkt</i> concentration; "excellent coordination of artillery and air support" (preparatory fires caused 20% of one Soviet tank division's casualties and "destroyed all of that formation's higher-headquarters communications"); the outer ring east of Minsk closed in six days, "averaging 50 miles per day"; Glantz's attribution to "superior operational readiness, training, command and control, technology and equipment, combat experience, and the attainment of strategic surprise" (US Army CGSC/DTIC, <i>Winning Battles and Losing the War</i>)	Order No. 270, 16 Aug 1941: "These shameful facts of surrender to our sworn enemy testify that there are unstable, cowardly... elements in the ranks of the Red Army... Can we put up with in the Red Army cowards, deserters who surrender themselves to the enemy...? No we can not!... Cowards and deserters must be destroyed"; commanders who surrender are "malicious deserters whose families are subject to arrest as a family, for violation of an oath and betrayal of their homeland" (Wikisource text)	State-enforced misattribution + censorship. The order names specific generals (Kachalov, Ponedelin, Kirillov) and prescribes shooting on the spot and family arrest (Wikisource); the encirclements it was reacting to were produced by "successful blitzkrieg strategy" that "disorganized the Soviet defense system," while pre-war Red Army "efficiency and morale of... command staff was low as a result of Stalin's purges" (Wikipedia, Order No. 270)	High. A structural/operational asymmetry is legally re-defined as individual treachery, with the accusing authority itself responsible for the institutional weakness — the 1450 pattern with a modern police state attached

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5	Byzantium, 1453	An adaptive siege system rather than a single wonder-weapon: sectorised command around a 126-stadia perimeter, a naval blockade of the whole sea wall, a planned bridge across the Horn, cannon allocated to sectors "accompanied by the founders who had cast them," and state resourcing of new artillery ("The Sultan immediately provided them in abundance with everything they needed") (Kritovoulos, in De Re Militari). Modern specialists argue the fall "had little to do with gunpowder," but with "the versatility and adaptability of the sultan in his tactical thinking" (BMCR review of <i>The Siege and the Fall of Constantinople in 1453</i>)	Contemporary Greek historians explained it by sin, oath-breaking and internal treachery, not by Ottoman institutions. Doukas: "Since the Byzantines broke so many oaths they had taken in the name of the Holy Trinity, in Lyon, in Florence, even in Hagia Sophia, nothing less could be expected than that all memory of them and their city will be wiped off the face of the earth"; the city appeared to him "treacherous and politically immature." Kritoboulos: "In the end, the fall of the city was God's will." Chalkokondyles: "The Romans believe that this disaster befell the Hellenes as a vengeance for the sack of Troy long ago" (The greatest misfortune in the Oikoumene)	Genuine explanatory framework (providential/moral), plus later legend accretion. The four historians "wrote after 1453, both as contemporaries and as witnesses" (same). The gate-betrayal and Marble Emperor material is later: "many of the myths surrounding the disappearance of Constantine were developed later and little evidence can be found to support them even in friendly primary accounts of the siege" (Wikipedia, Fall of Constantinople) — do not use the Kerkoporta story as contemporary evidence	Medium-High. Same genre (fiscal-artillery-siege state vs. a shrinking polity that cannot pay), same displacement onto moral failure; weaker because the explanation is theological rather than juridical-treason, and because artillery's causal weight is itself contested

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6	France, 1940	Frieser's revision: success came "not from the application of a carefully conceived blitzkrieg strategy, but from 'the accidental coincidence of the most varied factors'; the German army was "only semi-modern," "heavily dependent on horse transport"; the Allies had "more (and often better) tanks," but "most French tanks had no radios"; the secret lay in "a combination of tactics and technology, Panzer divisions plus speed and surprise" (Journal of Military History review of Frieser)	Two contemporaneous narratives, both non-systemic. (a) Pétain, 17 June 1940 : "L'infériorité de notre matériel a été plus grande encore que celle de nos effectifs... Trop peu d'enfants, trop peu d'armes, trop peu d'alliés, voilà notre défaite " (text of the broadcast). (b) The fifth-column frame, already fully formed in the House of Lords on 23 May 1940 : Viscount Elibank's "devilish new form of warfare" in five categories culminating in nationals "induce[d]... to side with them and do things for them which make them traitors to their own country," and, on the Meuse crossings, "There must have been some form of foul play there" (Hansard, 23 May 1940)	Regime-serving legal scapegoating. Vichy's Riom trial (opened 1942) alleged that Popular Front legislation "had undermined France's industrial and defence capabilities" and that the government was "weak in suppressing 'subversive elements and revolutionists'"; the defendants "demonstrated how the responsibility of the defeat of 1940 rested mainly on failures of the French general staff," and Hitler complained on 15 March 1942 that "not a word is spoken about the guilt of those responsible for this war. Only a lack of preparation for war is being discussed" (Wikipedia, Riom Trial)	Medium-High. Excellent for the <i>judicial</i> displacement mechanism and for demography/moralism substituting for operational analysis; weaker as a "misunderstood stack" case because the German advantage was partly accidental and because Pétain's stated causes were material, not treasonous

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7	Russia, 1904–05 (Port Arthur)	<i>n.a. in this session</i> — no fetched source describes the Japanese joint siege/naval system	The Russian state prosecuted the surrender. Stoessel was "sentenced to death for his capitulation of Port Arthur to Japanese forces," for "surrender[ing] before all defensive measures had been utilized; for failing to uphold his command, and for military infractions," with commutation recommended because the fortress was "surrounded by overwhelming forces" (New York Times , 21 Feb 1908)	Retrospective scapegoating, explicitly not a contemporary battlefield accusation. "никто из членов Военного совета, узнав о переговорах с врагом, не обвинил Стесселя в предательстве" — no member of the war council accused him of treason at the time; "Все обвинения были высказаны уже после войны, когда Стессель в 1906 году был уволен со службы и предан суду," and among defenders "кто-то называл Стесселя предателем, кто-то заявлял, что был счастлив служить под его началом" (antikvariat.ru)	Medium. Structurally close to Bazaine and to English handling of 1449–53 surrenders (a capitulation criminalised), but this session found no evidence that Russians framed the Japanese advantage as a <i>system</i> they failed to see, so the "misunderstood stack" half is unverified

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8	Iraq, 1991	Coalition ISR/air stack: first-night strikes stopped Iraq's air defence functioning "as an integrated whole"; feared losses of 25 aircraft on night one produced only one loss; 517 "Railroads and Bridges" targets struck, "470 with precision munitions," to prevent reinforcement and resupply; air attacks "indisputably destroyed considerable amounts of ground equipment and severely affected the morale of Iraqi forces" (<i>Journal of Strategic Studies</i> , "Saddam's Perceptions and Misperceptions")	Not treason but denial-plus-victory . Saddam, 3 March 1991 : "Where is it written in the [history] books to have a preparatory bombardment for one month and a half?... We should say in a decisive manner that [Iraq] is the master of the world, when it comes to faith... and human tenacity because there has never been anything [like this attack] in history." In 1994 he ordered commanders reading Schwarzkopf's and de la Billière's memoirs: "whenever you come across a lie or distorted facts, point them out... Their writings [are] full of propaganda and unfounded allegations" (same)	Censorship + institutionalised blame-deflection. Iraqi corps commanders "recounted events in such a way as to deflect blame," and negative lessons could only be taught "according to the permission of the political or military leadership" (same). The pre-war misreading was of a <i>political</i> variable: "once five thousand of his troops die, he will not be able to continue this war" (Dec 1990) (<i>Deterrence and Saddam Hussein</i> , Air University)	Medium. Valuable as the <i>bargaining-expectation</i> variant of the Normandy pattern (the loser mis-modelled the adversary's will and cost tolerance rather than his hardware), but the attribution is victory-claiming, not treason

B. Secondary and qualified cases

Case	Why it is weaker, with evidence
Spanish conquest of Mexico/Peru, 1519–1533	The "stack" is real but not the one contemporaries named: standard colonial procedure ("acquiring a native ally... a native interpreter... display violence... publicly seizing a native ruler"), overwhelming indigenous manpower (final assault on Tenochtitlán "with 200,000 native allies"), disease, disunity, and the steel sword; muskets, cannon, armour, horses and dogs were "not of great consequence... because they were in short supply" (Wikipedia, <i>Seven Myths of the Spanish Conquest</i>). The omen/supernatural explanation is post-conquest construction, not contemporary: Sahagún's students, "beginning in the 1560s and '70s, wrote down what no indigenous person had ever said before — namely, that their forefathers had been paralysed even before 1519 by the appearance of terrifying omens," and Fernández-Armesto "traces all the omens to precedents in three Greek and Latin books, by Plutarch, Josephus and Lucan, as well as the Bible"; the codex itself dates the same portent to four, eight and ten years before contact in different books (Mexicolore, "The myth of the omens"). An indigenous account written in 1570 does record technological awe — harquebuses called "yllapas" because they "emit[ted] bolts of thunder like the sky itself," horses as "very large animals with silver feet," Spaniards resembling <i>viracochas</i> (Titu Cusi Yupanqui, trans. Julien) — but this is wonder, not a treason narrative. Use only with explicit dating; do not cite "Moctezuma thought Cortés was a god."
Pakistan, 1971	Yahya Khan's address of 16 Dec 1971 attributed collapse to being "significantly outnumbered cut off supplies and by land sea, and air due to the enemy's blockade," facing "a treacherous and merciless adversary, heavily armed and supported by a superpower," and to India's "imperialist ambitions" (NYT text). The official inquiry went the <i>other</i> way — toward institutional and moral self-criticism, not treason: defeat was "not merely the result of military factors alone, but... the cumulative result of political, international, moral and military factors," rooted in "the process of moral degeneration among the senior ranks of the Armed Forces... set in motion by their involvement in Martial Law duties in 1958," and "The foundation of this defeat was laid way back in 1958 when the Armed Forces took over the country" (Hamoodur Rahman Commission Report, Dawn text). The Indian side genuinely was an integrated politico-military system — an apex core group that "functioned very efficiently," a Secretaries Committee for war preparations, calibrated support to the Mukti Bahini, the 9 Aug 1971 Indo-Soviet treaty, and timing chosen for closed Himalayan passes (IDSA, <i>Journal of Defence Studies</i>) — but the loser partly <i>did</i> see it. Qualified analogue only.
Argentina, 1982 (useful negative control)	The Rattenbach commission attributed defeat to combat power and British capability, explicitly not betrayal: the "bloqueo total" imposed "serias restricciones logísticas que afectaron el poder de combate"; British "aviación... embarcada y... abundancia de sus helicópteros de transporte y combate" produced "una gran libertad de acción para ejercer la iniciativa"; and "el desenlace [es] la natural consecuencia de la relación del poder de combate integralmente considerado, lo que también incluye... la capacidad de los mandos tácticos británicos y el valor y adiestramiento de sus tropas" (Informe Rattenbach, conclusiones finales). It does note US "apoyo político y logístico" to the UK, but frames no conspiracy (same). Include in the chapter as the case that shows treason narratives are <i>not</i> automatic.
Crécy, 1346	Froissart describes a genuinely integrated English tactical system — three divisions, archers "in the manner of a portcullis or harrow" with men-at-arms behind, a reinforcing second division, "a hedge of archers," Cornish and Welsh infantry with "large knives" passing through the ranks, and fire so dense "it seemed as if it snowed" (Froissart, Crécy, Bloomsbury primary source). This session did not verify a <i>French</i> contemporary treason attribution, so the case is listed but unproven: French attribution — n . a .
Battle of Diu, 1509	Included in the brief as a possible Portuguese-superiority case, but recent scholarship inverts it: Diu had "thick walls, cannons and a chain," Malik Ayyaz fielded "shallow-draft, oared warships" with "much greater manoeuvrability," a Venetian-built galleon squadron crewed by "Arab sailors, Turkic Mamluk archers and Black African arquebusiers," spies the Portuguese thought "the best in India," and at Chaul "Hussein, Ayyaz and Mahmud Begada coordinating a tripartite assault" (The Indian Economic and Social History Review, "Giving the Devil His Diu"). Not a usable analogue: the asymmetry the chapter needs is not there.
US railroads / Prussian absorption, 1864–1870	The DTIC study documents rail-and-depot logistics as an operational system (a freight locomotive carrying "as much as 150 tons at five times the speed of wagons"; "A single rail line could provision an entire field army over hundreds of miles") (DTIC, <i>Prussian Absorption of U.S. Lessons in the Military Uses of Railroads</i>), but the fetched portion covers the Atlanta campaign, not the 1870 French misreading. Background only.

C. Synthesis: when does "treason" get invoked?

1. **The trigger is invisibility of cause, not scale of loss.** In every high-ranking case the defeat was produced by things with no battlefield silhouette: a permanent tax and paid garrisons (1445–53), staff-computed march rates and a cavalry report acted on within hours (1870), a rolling barrage plus counter-battery plus American replacements plus blockade attrition (1918), encirclement tempo of 50 miles a day (1941), and a first-night collapse of an "integrated whole" air-defence network (1991). Sources: [Musée de l'Armée](#); [Wikipedia](#), Bazaine; [Saber & Scroll](#); [DTIC ADA312212](#); [Journal of Strategic Studies](#). Where destruction was visible and attributable — Argentine commanders watching British helicopters and carrier aviation — the inquiry produced a materialist verdict and no treason claim ([Informe Rattenbach](#)).

2. **The specific cognitive trigger is an arithmetic impossibility.** Nasser's inference is the clearest statement of the mechanism anywhere in this dossier: because the enemy struck "from the west" and hit "all military and civilian airports" at once, it followed "that he was given facilities that go beyond his capabilities, exceeding his calculated strength" ([American Rhetoric](#)). When the observed output exceeds the loser's model of enemy capacity, an unseen agent — a foreign fleet, a domestic traitor — is postulated to balance the equation. The Kentish commons perform the same inference in 1450: the simultaneous loss of law, trade, sea and France must have a single hidden agent, "his traitors about him" ([Fordham](#)).

3. **Surrender and capitulation, not battlefield death, are what get criminalised.** Bazaine (Metz), Stoessel (Port Arthur), Kachalov/Ponedelin/Kirillov (encirclements), Suffolk (ceded Maine): all are prosecutions of *bargaining decisions* taken under systemic pressure. Order No. 270 is the limit case, converting the act of being encircled into "betrayal of their homeland" with family arrest attached ([Wikisource](#)); the Bazaine defence names the sociology out loud — weak peoples "cherchent une victime; ils l'immolent" ([Le Droit Criminel](#)).

4. **Four distinct causal types, which the chapter should keep separate.**

- *Genuine misunderstanding within an available worldview:* Byzantine providentialism — sin, oath-breaking, Trojan vengeance ([scispace PDF](#)).
- *Elite self-exculpation:* Hindenburg/Ludendorff, who knew the truth on 1 Oct 1918 and arranged for others to sign ([GHDI Thaer](#); [GHDI testimony](#)).
- *Fabrication and censorship:* the 1967 collusion claim, denied even by Soviet intelligence yet carried into textbooks ([zionism-israel](#); [MEQ](#)); Iraqi after-action reporting "in such a way as to deflect blame" ([JSS](#)).
- *Later myth:* the Kerkopoorta/Marble Emperor cycle ([Wikipedia](#)) and the Mexica omens invented in the 1560s–70s ([Mexicolore](#)).

5. **Institutional asymmetry is the recurring blind spot, and money is its usual form.** The English case is fiscal at root — taxation "slumped since 1430" while conquered-territory revenue evaporated ([Osprey sample](#)) — against a French crown that had converted the *taille* into permanent revenue and paid troops "in both times of war and peace" ([Musée de l'Armée](#)). Its twentieth-century analogues are Germany with "little to no reserves left" facing continuous American reinforcement ([Saber & Scroll](#)) and Pakistan's inquiry tracing 1971 to 1958 ([HRC report](#)).

Notably, one of these — the HRC — is the counter-example that shows a defeated elite *can* reach the institutional diagnosis, when the inquiry is empowered to look past the last campaign.

6. Caution the chapter must state explicitly. The "stack" story is itself vulnerable to over-reading. Frieser dissolves 1940 into "the accidental coincidence of the most varied factors" ([JMH review](#)); the leading specialist volume on 1453 concludes the fall "had little to do with gunpowder" ([BMCR](#)); Restall dismantles the technological reading of the Spanish conquest ([Wikipedia](#)); and Diu shows the "European gunnery revolution" reading failing outright ([IESHR](#)). The argument should be that treason narratives and technological-determinist narratives are *both* substitutes for institutional analysis.

D. Recommendation: the three best comparators for a chapter on the Artillery State

- 1. France 1870 — the juridical twin.** It gives the full sequence in eighteen months: a fiscal-industrial-staff system converting information into movement (5 vs 15 miles a day; the 15 August patrol order), a wartime accusation of treason by the head of government ("Le maréchal Bazaine a trahi !"), and a formal treason trial ending in a death sentence — exactly the Suffolk/Somerset arc, with far richer documentation ([Wikipedia](#), [Bazaine](#); [Daloz](#), [Gambetta](#); [Le Droit Criminel](#)). It also supplies the historiographical epigram the chapter needs: strong nations do not accuse their unlucky generals of treason; weak ones "cherchent une victime."
- 2. Germany 1918 — the attritional-institutional twin, with proof of bad faith.** The pairing of the private 1 October 1918 admission with the public 18 November 1919 testimony is the single best documented instance of an elite knowingly substituting betrayal for system failure, and the underlying causes (manpower exhaustion, blockade-era industry, allied collapse, combined-arms tempo at Amiens) map onto the English 1449–53 problem of unpayable garrisons and no relief ([GHDI Thaeer](#); [GHDI testimony](#); [Saber & Scroll](#)).
- 3. Byzantium 1453 — the period-adjacent siege-state twin.** It is the only case within a generation of Normandy where an artillery-and-fiscal siege system met a polity that could not pay, and where the defeated wrote their own explanation: divine wrath for oath-breaking, internal treachery, Trojan vengeance — with the outright betrayal legends demonstrably later ([Kritovoulos](#); [scispace PDF](#); [BMCR](#); [Wikipedia](#)). Using it also disciplines the argument, since the specialists deny gunpowder primacy.

Runner-up, if a fourth is wanted: Egypt 1967, purely as the cleanest statement of the inferential mechanism ("facilities that go beyond his capabilities") and of how such a claim survives into official memory ([American Rhetoric](#); [zionism-israel](#)).

E. Evidence gaps (do not fill from memory)

Gap	Status
Israeli 1967 intelligence/airpower system, described from a fetched source	n . a . — this session verified only the Arab attributions and their refutation
Japanese joint system, 1904–05	n . a .

Gap	Status
French contemporary chronicle attributions for Crécy (Genoese "treachery")	n . a .
Full text of the parliamentary articles of impeachment against Suffolk (1450)	n . a . — only the secondary summary of the secret Maine clause and the treason suspicion was fetched (Wikipedia)
Doukas on the Kerkoporta specifically, in a fetched edition	n . a . — treat the story as later legend pending direct verification (Wikipedia)
Gulf War Air Power Survey text (fetched only as a search result, not read)	n . a .